File



Category: **Hand Tools - Cutting & Shaping** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 23 labs

Covers these lab items: File Handle (Wooden; File set; Flat Basted File; Flat file; Flat file Rasp); Flat file Rough); Flat Smooth File; Half Round (Wood rasp File); RasW; Round Basted File; Round file; Triangle file; Triangular files

What it is used for

A file removes small amounts of material to smooth, shape, or finish a workpiece. Select the correct file profile and cut for the material and required finish.

How to use

1. Inspect the file teeth, tang, and handle for wear or damage.
2. Select a suitable flat, round, half-round, or other file for the task.
3. Secure the workpiece firmly in a vice or approved holder.
4. Hold the file by its handle and support it safely with the other hand where appropriate.
5. Apply controlled forward strokes with suitable pressure and lift or ease pressure on the return stroke.
6. Check the workpiece frequently to avoid removing too much material.
7. Clean the file using a suitable file brush after use.
8. Store the file with its teeth protected.

⚠ Safety

- Never use a file without a secure handle fitted to its tang.
- Wear eye protection and keep hands away from sharp workpiece edges.
- Do not use a file as a lever or striking tool.
- Secure the workpiece before filing to prevent slipping.

Care & storage

- Remove filings with a file brush rather than bare fingers.
- Keep files dry and store them separately to protect their teeth.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.